

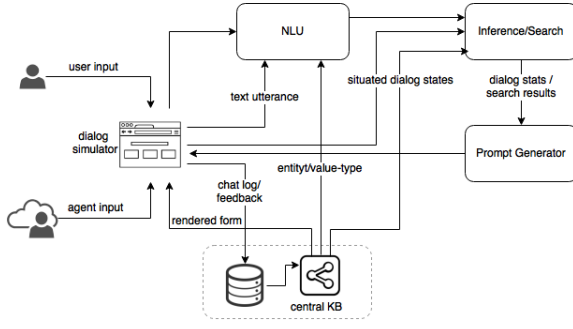


Figure 1: Architecture of the Framework

covers the domain entities (e.g., “apartment”), their semantic relations (e.g., “has-attribute”), and generic characteristics (e.g., expected data types, ranges, operations) associated with the entities, all generated in a domain agnostic way. We then generate the dialog components based on the extracted CKR, thus allowing seamless adaptation from one domain to another.

State Tracking and Inference

To identify the user intents we use a natural language classifier (?) trained on chat data¹, where the domain dependent tokens are delexicalised. To facilitate interactive search across domains for CS, we first identify a set of generic operations, such as ADD, DELETE, UPDATE that are useful for updating the dialog states and forming queries. The best performing classifier shows a promising accuracy of 89% in a test dataset containing over 200 utterances.

Dialog state is tracked using semantic matching. We map user utterance to the elements in CKR in three consecutive steps, i.e, (1) literal matching, (2) fuzzy matching - which identifies the approximate matches between entities, and (3) vector representation matching - which supports matching word embedding representations of related entities. Our framework is modular and supports plug-n-play of different semantic matching methodologies.

Given the last user intent, dialog state and previous dialog acts, the conversational agent either issue an API call using the query graph generated based on CKR or request more information to optimize the search experience. Information theory based measures are used to determine the slot to be requested.

Dialog Simulator

The dialog simulator generates various conversational environments in a Wizard-of-OZ fashion (?), which are configured to interface with the crowd-sourcing platforms. Figure 2 presents the interface rendered based on relevant content in CKR. It can simulate and log the process followed by human agents: a) to access the requested information based on identified user intent, and b) to convert that information to dialog prompts. The human agents can also provide feedback on the system’s output during the real-time interactions. Compared to many existing chat log annotating tools, our frame-

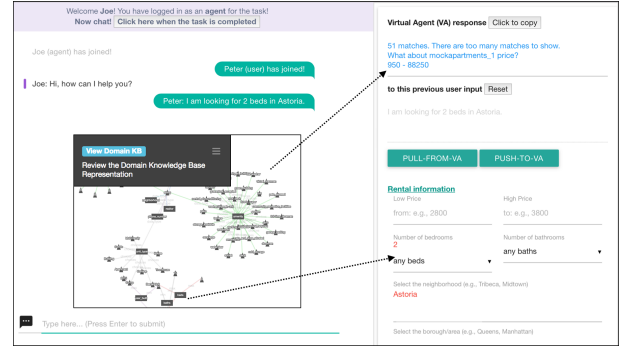


Figure 2: Dialog Simulator Interface

work captures real-time information that is difficult for human annotators to provide offline.

Case Studies

We apply the proposed framework on two independent domains: (1) rental apartments (2) restaurants. For the former, we create a mock database that includes information about #bedroom, transportation, location. As illustrated in Figure 2, the conversational agent could list search results based on users request and provide the guidance on how to optimize the query toward the goal. For the development of the later, we only replace the domain database and re-generate CKR. The conversational agent appears to perform comparably on the new domain.

Conclusion and Future Work

We propose a unified framework of Implicit Dialog for Conversational Search grounded by a centralized knowledge representation. It facilitates fast prototyping and aims at making existing development and chat data reusable and adaptable to new domains. As future work, we plan to conform the central knowledge representation with schema.org to enable the broader practice on domain adaptations.

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¹<https://datasets.maluuba.com/Frames>.

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